Germany was the right thing for Rose? She couldn't make sense of it. And yet, if she went to Germany maybe she could provide for herself and Rose. The idea twisted inside her. Maître Mallon was a good man who'd tried to help others, even as he'd lost everything. Six months ago, his eyes shone bright, and he'd worn a well-tailored suit with a crisp white shirt and sharply starched collar. Now, she barely recognized him—his eyes were dull, his hair had thinned, hanging like threads around his face. Even his shirt was gray and creased.

"It's the politicians who fuel this war," he said, voice hard. "Pétain and Laval send our young men there instead of putting them in uniforms, but no one calls them traitors." He took a breath. "You're the one stuck in the crossfire—so you must choose what's right for you. And for your sister."

Simone's dead body being carried out of the hut flashed in her mind. Was he warning her that she and Rose might share a similar fate if she didn't find a way out?

He sighed, looking her in the eye. "Your sister said you risked yourself to help the winemaker's family. That's who you are. That's what will never change. Your heart is good, no matter where you end up."

Maman's words came to her: *keep a good heart*. It was all she could control. As long as she kept it as her true north, where she was sent didn't matter. She'd carry it.

"Maybe you're right," Léa said quietly.

Rose leaned forward, her eyes shining with sudden apprehension. "But you have to do it only if it's your decision. Don't do it because of me. I couldn't bear it if something happened to you over there, and it was all my fault." She glanced at Maître Mallon. "We don't know what life will be like over there."

He nodded, understanding. But Léa's mind was turning over. It was a difficult decision to make, and though she knew Rose now had misgivings out of concern for her, she must think with her head, not her heart.

"Believe me," Léa said, "if I stay in here, I know something terrible will happen to me." She shook her head. "War is about money and power in the hands of men. They don't care about us." She looked down at her hands, wishing the choice, the world and her country were different.

"Léa's right," Maître Mallon said. "I've lost everything for my principles. Now, I can't help anyone, not even myself. Principles don't feed